

Zhe Chen 陈哲

zc2325@ic.ac.uk / ssyzc1011@gmail.com

github.com/CZ114

Personal website: <https://cz114.github.io/>



Education

Imperial College London	2025.10 – 2026.09
MRes, Medical Robotics Research completed; formal degree award pending	
University of Nottingham Ningbo China	2021.09 – 2025.06
BEng (Hons), Electrical and Electronic Engineering First-Class Honours	

Technical Skills

Agents and Evaluation: Function Calling, RAG, workflows and memory; BFCL calibration, retrieval evaluation, LOSO, ablation studies and evidence traceability.

Algorithm Foundations: Python, PyTorch, A2C/DQN, federated learning and pseudo-labelling; systematic study of Transformer/Attention and the principles of SFT, RLHF and PPO.

Robotics and Embedded Systems: ESP32-S3, I2S, BLE, UDP, MQTT, Coppeliasim, robot kinematics, Ubuntu, Jetson Nano and Altium Designer.

Research Experience

Imperial College London • Hamlyn Centre • I-thread Lab	Current
Research Assistant (RA) AD-related wearable sensing, AI agents and speech research	

UNNC Smart Medicine Laboratory	2023.09 – 2025.07
Research Intern / Project Lead Smart-Home IoT and Federated Learning for Sleep Apnoea	

- Addressed the lack of expert labels for home heart-rate data. Built an M5Stack/ESP32 + MQTT gateway, configured FATE/PyTorch experiments, and ran **confidence-thresholded pseudo-labelling and four federated training rounds**, comparing pseudo-labels with a control treating home samples as normal.
- Achieved **81% external-test accuracy in round four versus 76% for the control (+5 percentage points)**; sleep-apnoea class precision / recall were **0.93 / 0.78**, supporting the feasibility of improving models with unlabelled home data.
- Contributed to drafting a collaborative manuscript as a listed co-author, providing experimental evidence for collaborative modelling with home data lacking expert annotations.

Speech Evidence & Clinician Report Chat	2026
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Imperial College London • Hamlyn Centre • I-thread Lab | Research Support
Manuscript in preparation • Target journal: Nature Medicine

- Assisted with checking and verifying speech metrics within the collaborative research project.
- Helped organise the report page and its existing content for review.
- Implemented part of the chat functionality within the report interface.

Projects

Multimodal AI Analysis Platform for Alzheimer's Disease Research

2026.01 – 2026.09

Imperial College London | Hamlyn Centre · I-thread Lab | MRes Research

Developed a **wearable-to-agent research platform** for multimodal monitoring, integrating ESP32 sensing, signal processing, retrieval and agent workflows into evidence-linked reports.

- **Multimodal sensing:** Integrated PPG, GSR, IMU and audio on ESP32-S3; sustained approximately **50 Hz** acquisition with no detected frame loss across **136,562 frames / 27 serial recordings**.
- **Heart-rate estimation:** Combined spectral analysis, autocorrelation and motion suppression; achieved **MAE 5.57 bpm vs 11.84 bpm** for the device baseline (PPG-DaLiA, 15 participants, LOSO).
- **Agent workflows:** Built deterministic tools, retrieval, memory and bounded workflows; improved movement accuracy from **35.7% to 81.4%** in a fixed-model ablation, with parsing failures reduced from **15 to 0**.
- **Movement recognition:** Used 18-feature inputs for 5-class recognition; achieved **82.9% accuracy / 0.804 macro-F1**, versus **78.6% / 0.713** for random forest (70 recordings, 6 healthy volunteers, LOSO).
- **RAG and retrieval:** Implemented hybrid retrieval and HyDE comparisons; achieved **Recall@10 = 0.846** and **MRR = 0.753–0.774** on a 24-question internal set.
- **Tool-use and reporting:** Aligned the in-house BFCL scorer with official decisions on **400/400 cases** (both scored **91.25%**); **66/70 (94.3%)** reports met all traceability checks.
- **AgentClinic simulation:** Reduced mean dialogue turns for all six models; two model conditions improved task accuracy from **53% / 77% to 67% / 87%**.

Reinforcement Learning for Port Container Relocation

2024.08 – 2025.06

University of Nottingham Ningbo China | Undergraduate Dissertation

- Built a three-dimensional container-yard simulator to reduce unnecessary handling; designed state representations and reward functions, and implemented A2C/DQN training and evaluation pipelines.
- Against a **random-action baseline**, DQN reduced rehandles by approximately **23% in simple scenarios**, while A2C reduced handling moves by approximately **40% in complex scenarios**, demonstrating scope for learning-based scheduling improvements.

Awards

Best IoT Project Award – DeskPal, UNNC (EEEE3124)

2024.12

DeskPal – Embedded AI Companion

2024.12

University of Nottingham Ningbo China | Embedded ML and IoT

- Built a Wio Terminal desktop companion; trained an **Edge Impulse MLP** for three motion classes (idle, rise and wave) and deployed on-device inference.
- Integrated environmental sensing, LCD expression / reward states and **bidirectional MQTT** for interactive feedback, reminders and data exchange.

Open-Source Tools

Vibedog-for-agents 2026.05 – 2026.06 | AI-assisted development

Agent activity display, human approval and a stop control. github.com/CZ114/Vibedog-for-agents

esp32-audio-ai | Audio acquisition and transcription precursor to the main project

ESP32 audio capture, Whisper transcription, and pause / speech-rate statistics.

github.com/CZ114/esp32-audio-ai